

# Changing Face of MBA

At a time when top business schools are moving away from creating cogs in the wheel to creating leaders for India's burgeoning economy, IIM-A, IIM-B and IIM-C continue to remain the ABC of management education

| By Diksha Madhok |

**S**arath Babu, who was born in a slum in Chennai, started his food business with a paltry seed capital of Rs 2,000. Three years later, his annual turnover is Rs 7 crore. And this 29-year-old is not ready to take a break yet. He has bigger, even more ambitious plans which he hinted at when he contested the 2009 Lok Sabha elections from Chennai South. Interestingly, his success tale is similar to another super achiever—Kaushalendra, who founded the Kaushalya Foundation, which provides a holistic food supply chain to empower marginal farmers and vegetable vendors in Bihar. He may have started with a meagre initial investment but has set his revenue target at Rs 100 crore by 2010.

Both these young entrepreneurs have one thing in common: their alma mater, the Indian Institute of Management, Ahmedabad (IIM-A). They both shunned lucrative offers from top

companies to start their own ventures.

Top business schools are moving away from creating cogs in the wheel to creating leaders for India's burgeoning economy, and IIM-A leads the pack. It has been an indisputable leader in the last six years in the BUSINESS TODAY-Nielsen Survey and its rank in 2009 is no different. What is it that has consistently distinguished IIM-A from other colleges in the country? "There is no comparison with the rest. At IIM-A, the curriculum and the pedagogy is routinely revised to bring in newer elements based on theoretical developments as well as emerging needs of practice," says Samir K. Barua, director, IIM-A. It comes as no surprise that the heads of some of the leading companies in the world are IIM-A alumni.

Another prestigious institution, IIM-Bangalore has steadfastly clung to the second position and the rank order of the top four institutes has remained unchanged since last year. But there is a significant turbulence as we go down the ladder. Jamnalal

Bajaj Institute of Management Studies (JBIMS), Mumbai, has leapt two places this year and is now perched at number five. Two schools have broken into the top 10 for the first time—Amity Business School (ABS), Noida, and Loyola Institute of Business Management (LIBA), replacing IIM-Indore and Faculty of Management Studies (FMS), Delhi. The rankings for the latter two were particularly weak among the recruiters thereby affecting their overall position. MBA wannabes and the current crop of management students came out to be the main adherent for LIBA, whereas ABS has garnered appreciation from all the communities interviewed for the survey. Indian School of Business (ISB), Hyderabad, a new entrant in the survey, has debuted at 13th rank.

The three IIMs continue to dominate the rankings on almost all counts. Last year, 2,60,000 candidates appeared for the Common Aptitude Test (CAT) exam, up by nearly 50,000 from 2007. In 2003, they were less than a lakh. This exponential rise